# AT LEAST 500 ARE DEAD

## NO HOPE LEFT FOR SAFETY OF ANY BUILDINGS

(Continued From Page 1.)

the fire away from the swept section toward Mission street, they made their way to the point of the hotel until the old place began to crumble away in the blaze.

The City Hall is a complete wreck The entire part of the building from Larkin street down City Hall avenue to Leavenworth, down from top of dome tothe steps is ruined. The colossal pillars supporting the arches at the entrance fell into the avenue far out across the car tracks and the thousands of tons of bricks and debris that followed them piled into a mountainous heap.. The west wing sagged and crumbled, caving into a shapeless mass. At the last every vestige of stone was swept away by the shock and the building laid bare nearly to its McAllister street side. Only a shell remained to the north, and the huge steel frame stood gaping until the fire that swept from the Hayes Valley set the debris ablaze and hid the structure in a cloud of smoke. Every document of the City government is destroyed. Nothing remains but a ghastly past of the once beautiful structure. It will be necessary to entirely rebuild the Hall.

Mechanics' Pavilion, covering an entire block, went before the flames in a quarter of an hour. .The big wooden structure burned like tinder and in less time than it takes to write it was flat upon the ground.

The flames had come from the west, this time fanned by a lively wind. Down from Hayes Valley they swooped, destroying residences in entire rows, sending to cinders the business houses and leaping the gaps caused by the dynamiting of homes. They had stolen their way out from the Mission while a dense crowd blocked that street. So quickly did they make their way to the north of Market that their approach was not noticed. When it was realized that the danger had come to this particular residence section, the police and the cavalry drove the crowd back in haste to the north and out of harm's way. Down Hayes street playing the cross streets coming on like a demon, the fire swept over St. Ignacious Church, leveled barns and houses, and, as if accomplishing a purpose long desired, blazed down to the front of Mechanics' Pavilion. Only shortly before the patients in this crude hospital had been removed to other hospitals in outlying districts.

From the big shed the flames spread to the north, east, south and west, everywhere. Confusion reigned. Women fainted and men fought their way into the adjoining apartment houses to rescue something from destruction — anything, if only enough to cover their wives and their babies when the cold of the night came on. There was a scene that made big, brave men cry. There were the weeping tots in their mothers' arms wailing with fear of the awful calamity; salesmen and soldiers fighting to get the women out of harm's way through the crowd; heroic dashes in the ambulances and the patrol wagons after the sick and injured and willing men, powerless as the mouse in the cluth of the lion, ready to fight the destroyer, but driven back step by step while their homes went down before them.

It was when the terrible shock of the first big rumbler was passing off, that San Franciscocans, sent scurrying into the streets in their nightclothes, turned to the east and south and first saw the pillars of flame that have bred such wicked destruction.

Down in the wholesale district south of the cable and along through the section facing the city's front, the flames appeared. Fire shot into the air from ever corner. Before the first alarm was sent in the fire was beyond control. The city was beyond saving from the time that the first blaze broke toward the heavens.

Gradually the flames stole along Mission and Howard streets, and then rapidly they made their way from building to building until Seventh street was reached. Out into the warehouse district bounded by Sansome on the west and the bay on the north and east they went and such structures as the Wellman Peck Building and the Tillman, Bendel building were made into whitened wills, left tottering in the breeze that was blowing. Everywhere were scenes of horror. People rushed frantically through the streets, looking for missing relatives and rescue parties were formed to go into the burning blocks to save life. Here and there the grim-faced men dug out the unfortunates who had gone down into the shapeless piles of debris when the big shock came. Man fought to save man and many times did the sickened crowds turn away as they saw the rescuers driven back by the flames that reacheddown through the ruins ti claim their victims.

Steadily the fire found its way into the uptown retail districts. From the sout hand east the south side of Market was attacked. One by one the familiar buildings went down. Levi Strauss and Company, Zellerbach and Company, Holbrook, Merrill and Stetson, Hicks-Judd Company, D. N. and E. Walters, W. W. Montague, the Donohoe estate building, Uhl Brothers, the Bancroft Building,—all the places that have made the San Francisco business district.. Everyone of them went.. They can't be enumerated.. The work of the fire demon was too complete to make that necessary. .From Mission to Market and east to Ninth the many-storied structures were gutted. True, many of these places had crumbled when the earth shook, but evidence of this was remooved in the path ff the flames.

From Second to Third streets Market street held its own until late in the afternoon. The Call Building was ablaze, but the Examiner Building, the Palace Hotel, the Grand, and the other structures toward Second street stood.. Two attempts were made to dynamite the new Monadnock Building when it was seen that the Hearst structure was doomed. And slowly came the blaze from Mission street just below Third, sweeping everything before it and igniting the Examiner Annex. Then the main building took fire and by two o'clock only the Third street wall was standing. Later the Palace took fire in the rear and the flames made quick proogress to Market street. By five o'clock Colonel Kirkpatrick's famous hotel was no more. The Grand went at the same time, and in a few minutes the flames had Market street again. At Sansome they combined with the fire on the north side of the street but the changeable winds kept the fire back from the buildings extending from this point to Kearney street.

At seven o'clock the entire region lying just back of the Hall of Justice was on fire. The dynamite did no good. From the Fairmount Hotel now could be seen the gigantic semicircle of flame extending from the Mission at about Thirteenth street down through the entire southern end of the city proper, along the channel, over the hill, along the waterfront, through the wholesale district and over onto Barbary Coast.

At nine o'clock the Crocker-Woolworth Bank Building was was on fire at the gore. Across from it is the railroad building and Masonic Temple. Only a row of small buildings separate it from the Chronicle Building.

Then the fire fighters prepared for the thing they hoped would not happen. It was certain that the fire would spread northward and join the inferno near the Hall of Justice. Dynamite was placed in the Hall of Justice to be sent into the air at the signal. The flames on lower Kearny street had gained the office buildings on the west side of the street. This means the doom of Chinatown. Thousands on thousands of Celestials scurried over Nob Hill to safety.

## PARDEE ISSUES PROCLAMATION

OAKLAND, April 18—Governor Pardee tonight issued a proclamation declaring tomorrow, Thursday, a legal holiday, and that all business be suspended throughout the State. This followed a conference held by the Governor with Mayor Mott, Lieutenant J. Anderson, of the Adjutant General's staff, and Judge Henry A. Melvin at the Mayor's office. Governor Pardee said he had sent Lieutenant Anderson to San Francisco to investigate conditions. The Governor came to Oakland as quickly as possible in order to be in touch at the nearest point with which he could keep in communication with San Francisco.

## BUILDINGS ARE ALL RUINED

Fire Chief Nick Ball and Fire Warden MacDonald, are making a tour of the City of Oakland condemning all buildings damaged by the earthquake and left in a menacing condition. The tower of the First Baptist church has been ordered torn down, and other structures throughout the city have also been placed under the official ban.

## EFFECTS HEROIC RESCUE

The disaster brought forth hundreds of heroic deeds. About the only persons in the awoke when the tremblor occurred were the mechanical workers of the newspapers, policemen and saloonmen. Among the heroes were Emile Dengel, foreman of "The Examiner" stereotyping department, and several of his men. After the first crash, and upon their escape from the building they were passing Krumm's cafe when they heard cries for help coming from beneath the debris of the place. Dengel rushed out to a passing hose cart, seized an axe, and with his great strength began chopping a hole through the structure to release its captive inmates.

A woman's voice kept saying from beneath the ruins, "I'm all right, hurry and get me out." The imprisoned people—Krumm, the proprietor, his wife and a waiter —were finally released, but none too soon for 20 minutes later flames consumed the fallen structure.

Later Dengel caught a vandal looting the body of a dead man, and upon Dengel seizing him the fellow turned and made a vicious cut at Dengel with a key-hole saw. He was finally overpowered and arrested by the police.

## NEWSPAPER ROW IS GUTTED

The Examiner and Call buildings gave the inferno of flame that swept up from the district south of Market street a stubborn fight and prevented the fire from sweeping up Kearny street. The two buildings burned slowly, and held out for hours, only to be finally gutted.

When the Winchester Hotel crumbled into ruins at 11 o'clock the cafe in the top of the twenty-story Call building began spouting fire. At that time Market street as far as Seventh street was burning as a single block from the Bohemian Cafe.

As the fire burned out in the top stories of the Call, it descended and turned the building into a fountain of flame.

At 12 o'clock the annex of the Hearst building took fire and a half an hour later the rear wall fell. Shortly afterwards the fire appeared through the frieze on the seventh floor, where the editorial rooms were located, but it was 3 o'clock before the windows of the lower floors began to belch flames.

The fire burned out gradually and the building remained standing, completely gutted.

At 4 o'clock the ground floor of the Call building began to burn again with redoubled fury, but the building stood amid the surrounding ruins, a denuded frame of blackened stone.

## MAYOR CONFERS WITH MILITARY

(Continued From Page 1.)

responded. Among those promptly on hand were Hartley and Herbert Law, capitalists, the brothers Magee of Thomas Magee & Sons, real estate men; J. Downey Harvey, of the Ocean Shore Railway Company; ex-Mayor James D. Phelan, Garrett McEnerney, the prominent attorney; ex-Judge C. W. Slack, W. H. Leary, manager of the Tivoli Opera House; J. T. Howell, of Baldwin & Howell, real esate men; former City Attorney Franklin K. Lane, also many others.

No time was lost at the meeting, and almost the first words spoken by the Mayor breathed strongly of the grimness of the disaster and its accompaniments.

"Let it be given out," said the Mayor, sternly, "that three men have already been shot down without mercy for looting. Let it be also understood that the order has been given to all soldiers and policemen to do likewise without hesitation in the cases of any and all miscreants who may seek to take advantage of the city's awful misfortune. I will ask the Chief of Police and the representatives of the Federal military authorities here present if I do not echo their sentiments inthis?"

The uniformed officials to whom the Mayor turned as he spoke signified their acquiescence. and Chief Dinan stated also he would undertake the distribution throughout the city of printed proclamations making public the order.

Then the Mayor told those present of what had already been done t olighten the effects of the disaster. For one thing he had secured 2400 tents which were already in process of erection in Jefferson Square, Golden Gate Park and on the Presidio grounds, for the accommodation of the homeless.

Garrett McEnerney, moved, and the large number of other prominent citizens present unanimously voted, that the Mayor be authorized to draw checks for any amount for the relief of the suffering, all of the gentlemen present pledging themselves to make such checks good. Ex-Mayor Phelan was appointed chairman of a Relief Finance Committee with full authority to select his associates.

The Mayor announced that orders had already been given forbidding the burning of either gas or electric currents, even where possible. During the fire citizens must get along with other light, as no chances could be taken of a renewed outbreak of flames. Police Chief Dinan stated that he had also instructed his men to announce all over the city that no fires were to be lighted in stoves or grates anywhere lest the chimneys should be defective as the result of the earthquake.

Then the statement was made that expressmen were charging $30 a load to haul goods—a rate which was prohibitive to poor people. The announcement provoked great indigation, and an immediate order from Mayor Schmitz, in which Dinan heartily concurred.

"Tell your men," said the Mayor, "to seize the wagons of all such would-be extortionists, and make use of them for the public good. The question of recompense will b eseen to later."

Then a further notice was ordered distributed as widely as possibly throughout the city instructing all householders to remain at home at night for protection of their families and property during the continuance of the trouble and excitement

It was at this point that the explosion of a heavy charge of dynamite used in blowing up a building a block away brought glass and cornice work in theHall of Justice crashing down. At once W. H. Leary and J. Downey Harvey urged that the Mayor at least immediately remove from the building. "Your life is too valuable, Mayor," said Mr. Harvey, "at this dreadful juncture for any unnecesary risk to be taken."

To this all present conceded, and a few moments later an adjournment was taken to the center of Portsmouth Square, across Kearney street. There, in close and dangerous proximity to a great pile of dynamite, brought thither to be used for the necessary destruction of buildings, the Mayor and his officials continued for some time longer to discuss the situation. When they finally separated it was with the agreement to meet again this morning at 10 o'clock at the Fairmont.